CSC 4370 – Web Programming

Project 1 Proposal: HavenMade – Recipe Studio

Student: Haven Freeman

Project Type: Individual Project

Selected Track: Recipe Studio

Technologies: HTML5 and CSS3

1. Project Overview

HavenMade is a budget-friendly recipe website designed to make cooking at home feel easier, more affordable, and more enjoyable. The website focuses on simple meals, comfort food, and recipes that do not require advanced cooking skills or expensive ingredients.

The idea behind HavenMade is to create a relaxing space where visitors can find meal inspiration without feeling overwhelmed. The website combines original food photography, easy-to-follow recipe information, and a warm, retro-inspired visual design.

The website's tagline is "Good food. Small budgets. A little peace in every recipe."

HavenMade will consist of four main pages: Home, Recipes, Recipe Details, and My Story.

2. Purpose and Target Audience

The purpose of HavenMade is to help visitors discover approachable recipes while providing a comfortable and enjoyable browsing experience.

The primary target audience includes:

- College students who want affordable meal ideas.
- Beginner cooks who need simple recipes and instructions.
- Young adults learning to prepare more meals at home.

- Anyone interested in comforting homemade food without spending a lot of money.

One challenge for this audience is deciding what to cook with limited time, money, or experience. HavenMade addresses this by presenting recipes in an organized format and allowing visitors to explore meals based on their preferences.

3. Website Structure and Navigation

HavenMade will include four HTML pages connected through a consistent navigation system.

Home Page – index.html

The homepage will introduce the HavenMade brand and its purpose. It will feature welcoming text, food photography, and selected recipes to encourage visitors to explore the website.

The homepage will include:

- A navigation bar with the HavenMade logo.
- A hero section introducing the website.
- Featured recipe cards.
- Buttons linking to the recipe collection.
- A footer with the website tagline.

Recipes Page – recipes.html

The Recipes page will display a collection of homemade meals using a responsive card layout.

Each recipe card will include a food photograph, recipe title, category, short description, and link to its instructions.

The featured recipes include:

1. Honey-Glazed Salmon Bowl
2. Chicken Noodle Soup
3. BBQ Chicken Flatbread Pizza
4. Tomato Soup and Grilled Cheese
5. Homestyle Chili
6. Sweet Golden Cornbread

The page will also include an interactive recipe recommendation feature that helps visitors choose a meal based on their cooking mood.

Recipe Details Page – recipe-detail.html

The Recipe Details page will provide additional information about the featured meals.

The page will organize recipe information into readable sections so visitors can find the ingredients and cooking instructions they need.

Recipe cards will link to the appropriate recipe information using HTML links and section identifiers.

My Story Page – about.html

The My Story page will introduce the person behind HavenMade and explain the inspiration for creating the website.

It will provide a more personal connection to the website and describe the goal of making cooking feel accessible and enjoyable.

The page will also include contact information.

4. Visual Design and Theme

HavenMade will use a cozy, retro-inspired kitchen theme. The goal is to make the website feel warm, welcoming, and playful while keeping the content easy to read.

The primary color palette will include cream, chocolate brown, soft pink, butter yellow, and sage green.

Cream will serve as the main background color, while brown will be used for much of the text. Pink, yellow, and green will provide accents for buttons, recipe categories, and interactive elements.

The design will include rounded cards, soft borders, consistent spacing, and welcoming typography.

Original photographs of homemade meals will be used throughout the website to make the content feel personal and authentic.

A consistent navigation bar, button style, color system, and card layout will help connect all four pages visually.

5. Planned Responsive Behavior

HavenMade will be designed to work on desktop computers, tablets, and mobile phones.

CSS Flexbox and Grid will be used to organize the page layouts.

On larger screens, recipe cards will appear in multiple columns to make use of the available space.

On smaller screens, the number of columns will decrease so the content remains readable without horizontal scrolling.

Navigation links, headings, buttons, and images will adjust to fit different screen sizes.

Media queries will control these layout changes.

The recipe recommendation interface will also adapt to narrower screens by rearranging its selection options.

6. HTML and CSS Implementation

The website will be created using HTML5 and CSS3 without requiring JavaScript.

Semantic HTML elements such as header, nav, main, section, article, and footer will be used to organize the content.

A shared CSS stylesheet will control the appearance of the website and help maintain consistency between pages.

CSS variables and reusable classes will be used for colors, spacing, buttons, and card components.

The website will also include CSS animations and transitions to make the experience more engaging.

These effects will be used for visual emphasis without interfering with readability or navigation.

7. Interactive Recipe Recommendation Feature

HavenMade will include an optional bonus feature: a CSS-only recipe recommendation engine.

This feature will be integrated directly into the Recipes page rather than placed on a separate page.

Visitors will be able to select one of four cooking moods:

- On a Budget
- Something Quick
- Comfort Food
- Something Sweet

After selecting an option, the interface will display a recommended recipe along with a matching label, a short explanation, and a link to the recipe instructions.

The feature will use HTML radio buttons and CSS selectors to display different recommendation cards.

It will simulate the appearance and interaction of a recommendation engine without using artificial intelligence, an external API, or JavaScript.

The recommendation interface will follow the same color palette, typography, and rounded-card design used throughout HavenMade.

8. Accessibility Considerations

Accessibility will be considered throughout the design and development process.

The website will include descriptive alternative text for food photographs, semantic HTML elements, and a logical heading structure.

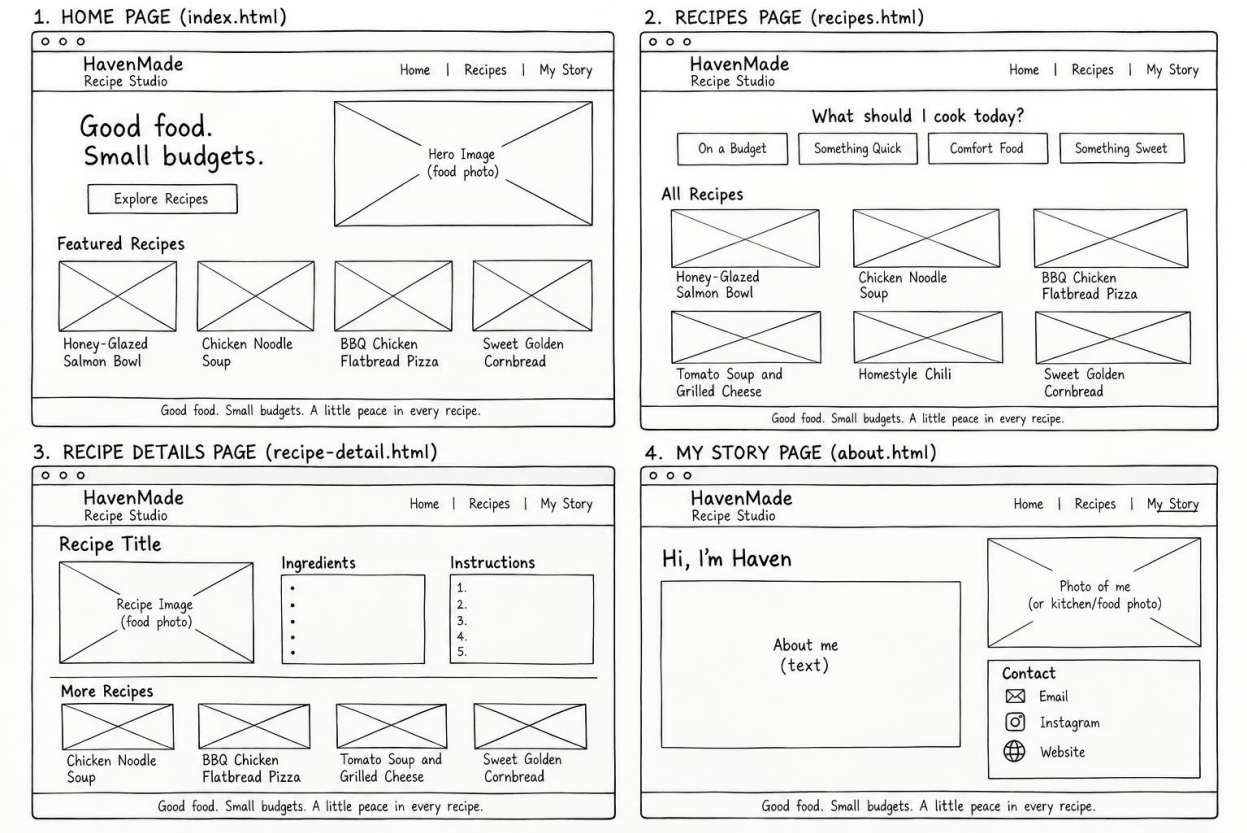
Navigation links and interactive controls will be designed for keyboard use.

Visible focus indicators will help users identify the currently selected element.

Text and background colors will be selected with readability in mind.

The website will also include reduced-motion support so users who prefer fewer animations can browse more comfortably.

9. Preliminary Wireframes



Wireframe 1: Home Page

Header: HavenMade logo and navigation links.

Hero section: Large welcoming heading, introductory description, food photograph, and a button leading to the Recipes page.

Featured recipes section: Recipe cards arranged in a responsive grid.

Footer: Website tagline.

Wireframe 2: Recipes Page

Header: Consistent navigation bar.

Introduction: Page heading and short description.

Recommendation section: Four selectable cooking moods and a recommendation result card.

Recipe collection: Six recipe cards with photographs, descriptions, and links.

Footer: Website tagline.

Wireframe 3: Recipe Details Page

Header: Consistent navigation bar.

Recipe content: Recipe title, photograph, ingredients, and step-by-step instructions.

Additional recipe sections: Other featured recipes organized into identifiable sections.

Footer: Website tagline.

Wireframe 4: My Story Page

Header: Consistent navigation bar.

Introduction: Personal heading and background information.

Story section: Explanation of the inspiration behind HavenMade.

Contact section: Contact information.

Footer: Website tagline.

10. Development and Project Management

The project will be managed using a Trello Kanban board.

Tasks will be organized into the following categories:

- Backlog
- To Do
- In Progress
- Review
- Done

The board will track website planning, design, HTML development, CSS styling, testing, documentation, and final delivery.

A development journal will document progress, technical problems, and decisions made during the project.

Git and GitHub will be used for version control and to maintain a record of website development.

11. Testing and Quality Assurance

The completed website will be tested to confirm that its pages and features function correctly.

Testing will include:

- Checking navigation links between all four pages.
- Verifying that recipe links lead to the correct information.
- Confirming that photographs and stylesheets load correctly.
- Reviewing desktop, tablet, and mobile layouts.
- Testing keyboard navigation and interactive controls.
- Checking the recipe recommendation feature.
- Reviewing heading structure, image alternatives, and readability.
- Checking that the deployed website works on the university's CODD server.

Testing results and any necessary corrections will be documented as part of the development process.

12. Expected Deliverables

The completed project will include:

1. A functional four-page website developed with HTML and CSS.
2. A responsive design suitable for desktop, tablet, and mobile screens.
3. Original food photography and recipe content.
4. CSS animations, transitions, and interactive styling.
5. An optional CSS-only recipe recommendation feature.
6. A GitHub repository containing the project files and development history.
7. A Trello Kanban board showing project tasks and progress.
8. A development journal and quality assurance notes.
9. A README explaining the website's structure, features, and implementation.
10. A website deployed to the university's CODD server.
11. A recorded project presentation and code walkthrough.
12. A text document containing the required project links.

13. Conclusion

HavenMade combines practical recipe information with a warm and approachable website design. The project demonstrates the use of semantic HTML, reusable CSS styling, responsive layouts, animations, and CSS-only interaction.

The main goal is to create a website that is useful for beginner cooks and students while also being visually appealing and easy to navigate.

By combining original recipe photography, a consistent design system, and an interactive recommendation feature, HavenMade provides a personalized recipe-browsing experience without requiring JavaScript or external services.